

Corporate Travel and Expense Policy

Global Operations Division – Internal Use Only

This document defines the official travel, reimbursement, information security, and business expense policies for employees, contractors, consultants, and authorized partners of the company. These rules apply to all business travel conducted within Europe, North America, South America, and all other international regions.

1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that business travel is conducted in a secure, cost-effective, transparent, and compliant manner. Employees are expected to use reasonable judgment while traveling on behalf of the company and must comply with all applicable regulations and internal procedures. This policy applies to: Full-time employees Part-time employees Contractors approved for travel reimbursement Executives and regional managers Temporary project staff

2. Travel Approval Workflow

All business travel must be approved before any booking is made. The standard approval chain is as follows: Employee submits travel request in the internal travel portal. Direct manager reviews business justification. Finance department validates budget availability. Human Resources confirms travel eligibility and compliance. Procurement or Travel Operations finalizes bookings. International travel exceeding 7 calendar days additionally requires approval from the Regional Director. Trips exceeding EUR 5,000 in total estimated cost require approval from the Chief Financial Officer.

3. Communication and Department Coordination

Employees traveling for business must maintain communication with the following departments where applicable: **Human Resources:** visa support, emergency contact updates, insurance matters. **Finance:** expense limits, reimbursement status, prepaid cards. **Information Security:** laptop encryption, VPN access, secure handling of confidential data. **Legal Department:** client agreements, export control questions, local compliance issues. **Travel Operations:** transportation, hotel booking assistance, itinerary changes. Project-related customer visits must also be coordinated with the assigned Account Manager.

4. Information Security During Travel

Business travel presents increased cybersecurity and data protection risks. The following rules are mandatory: Only company-managed devices may be used for business activities. All laptops must use full-disk encryption and multi-factor authentication. Public Wi-Fi may only be used together with the corporate VPN. Confidential documents must not be printed in public hotel business centers. Devices must never be left unattended in airports, conference venues, or taxis. USB storage devices from external parties are prohibited. Security incidents must be reported within 2 hours to the Information Security team. Employees traveling to high-risk countries may receive temporary restricted-access devices from IT Security.

5. Travel Booking Rules

Employees are required to use approved corporate booking tools whenever possible. The following restrictions apply: First-class airline tickets are prohibited. Business-class tickets are only permitted for flights longer than 8 hours and require Director approval. Low-cost carriers may be used when operationally reasonable. Train travel should be preferred for journeys under 5 hours within Europe. Five-star and luxury hotels are not permitted for business travel in Europe or the Americas. Hotel accommodation may not exceed EUR 200 per night including taxes, unless approved in writing by Finance. Employees should select standard-rate rooms only.

6. Meal and Daily Expense Limits

The company reimburses reasonable meal and incidental expenses based on location. Standard daily limits: Europe: EUR 65 per day United States and Canada: USD 85 per day South America: USD 60 per day Asia-Pacific: USD 75 per day Alcoholic beverages are generally non-reimbursable unless directly associated with approved customer entertainment. Personal entertainment expenses such as minibar usage, hotel spa services, or streaming services are not reimbursable.

7. Expense Reimbursement Procedures

Employees must submit expense claims within 14 calendar days after completing travel. Required documentation: Original or digital receipts Boarding passes Hotel invoices Conference registration confirmation Currency conversion evidence where applicable Reimbursement process: Employee uploads receipts into the expense management system. Direct manager validates business relevance. Finance performs compliance review. Approved reimbursements are paid through payroll or bank transfer. Incomplete or late submissions may result in delayed reimbursement or rejection.

8. Advance Payments and Corporate Cards

Employees may request travel advances for approved international trips. Advance payment conditions: Minimum trip duration: 3 business days Maximum standard advance: EUR 1,000 Executives may receive higher limits subject to CFO approval Unused advances must be returned within 10 business days after travel completion Corporate credit cards may only be used for authorized business expenses. Misuse of company-issued cards may result in disciplinary action.

9. Ground Transportation Policy

Employees should prioritize economical and safe transportation methods. Permitted transportation: Public transportation Standard taxi services Ride-sharing services approved by Procurement Economy rental vehicles Luxury vehicles, limousine services, and premium rideshare categories are not reimbursable unless required for security or executive protocol reasons.

10. Conferences and Client Entertainment

Conference attendance requires confirmation that the event supports business objectives and budget plans. Client entertainment expenses must: Have a documented business purpose Include attendee names and organizations Comply with anti-bribery and anti-corruption policies Remain moderate and reasonable in cost Cash gifts, personal gifts, or entertainment involving illegal or unethical activities are strictly prohibited.

11. Emergency and Health Procedures

Employees must review local travel advisories before departure. The company provides: International travel insurance Emergency medical assistance 24/7 security hotline support Evacuation assistance in crisis situations Employees must immediately notify Human Resources and Security Operations in the event of: Medical emergencies Loss or theft of company devices Political unrest or civil disturbances Natural disasters affecting travel plans

12. Compliance and Disciplinary Actions

Violations of this policy may result in: Expense reimbursement denial Temporary suspension of travel privileges Mandatory retraining Formal disciplinary action Termination of employment in severe cases Managers are responsible for ensuring team compliance and reporting repeated violations.

13. Appendix – Expense Examples

Expense Type	Reimbursable	Approval Required	Economy Flight	Yes	No	Business Class Flight (>8h)	Yes	No
Director Approval	Five-Star Hotel	No	Not Allowed	Standard Taxi	Yes	No	Luxury Vehicle Rental	No
Exception Approval	Client Dinner	Yes	Manager Approval					

This policy becomes effective immediately upon publication and supersedes previous travel and expense procedures. The company reserves the right to modify these policies at any time based on operational, legal, or financial requirements.